

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥2

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣3

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠5

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 10 9 7 5
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ 8 4

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K

♦ K 7 6

♣ Q J 10 5 2



♠ A 8 6 3

♥ J 8 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 7 6

♠ K 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ A K 3

NORTH has 17 points, counting 1 for the fifth Club.
She has a balanced distribution so she opens 1NT.

SOUTH is also balanced, so he does the math.

NORTH has either 15, 16 or 17, and with SOUTH's 18 the partnership total is either 33, 34 or 35. That is enough for a small slam, but below the 37 points needed for Grand Slam so he bids 6NT.

West

Pass

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥2

North

1NT

East

Pass

South

6NT

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 4
♥ Q J 5
♦ K J 10
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ 10 8 2

♥ 9 7 6 3

♦ 7 6

♣ J 10 9 6



♠ Q J 9

♥ A K 8

♦ A Q 5 3

♣ K Q 8

♠ A 6 5 3

♥ 10 4 2

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 5 2

The partner who is first sure what the final contract should be should just go ahead and bid it. This is called "She who knows, goes."

In this deal, for example, it is WEST who knows. She has a balanced 14 points, so when EAST indicates 20/21 points with his opening 2NT bid she KNOWS the partnership holds about 34/35 points.

Therefore she GOES to 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♣5

Board 3

East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 4
♥ J 5 3
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ 8 3

♠ 8 5 3
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 6 5



♠ 9 7 2
♥ 10 8 7 2
♦ 2
♣ A Q 10 4 2

♠ A 10 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ K Q J 10
♣ K J 7

SOUTH has a balanced 20 point hand - ideal to open 2NT.

NORTH has 7 points; he knows the partnership has either 27 or 28 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ 10 7 4 3
♦ A 9 8 2
♣ K Q

♠ Q J

♥ Q J 6 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2



♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 8

♦ K Q

♣ A J 10 7 4

♠ 10 9 8 3 2

♥ 9 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ 9 3

West

1NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♠Q

North

Pass

East

6NT

South

This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

EAST has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when WEST opens 1NT she KNOWS that together they must hold at least 33 points. They may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so EAST GOES to 6NT.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4
♥ K 7 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ A J 6

♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K 10 4



♠ A Q 7 2

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 3 2

♠ 10 6 3

♥ 10 8 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 9 8 5

NORTH has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT. (20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

West

Pass

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣3

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 3
 ♥ K 10 6
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 6
 ♥ Q J 7 4 2
 ♦ 6 3 2
 ♣ A 9 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ A 9 8
 ♦ Q 10 8
 ♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 7 5 4
 ♥ 5 3
 ♦ K J 7 5
 ♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 5			

After WEST passes initially, EAST opens 1NT.

With 9 points, WEST has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

EAST has a small problem - WEST's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.